

Keshav's article lays out something simple: a three-pass method for reading research papers, instead of just starting at the beginning and reading straight through like most people do. The first pass is a quick scan: title, abstract, introduction, headings, conclusion. The goal isn't to understand everything, it's to decide whether the paper is even worth your time, and to be able to answer what he calls the five Cs (category, context, correctness, contributions, clarity). The second pass gets you the actual content of the paper without all the fine details, this time looking carefully at figures and graphs too, checking things like whether axes are labeled properly and whether results have error bars. By the end, you should be able to explain the paper to someone else. The third pass is where you truly understand the paper by basically trying to re-implement its ideas yourself, making the same assumptions the authors did, and comparing your version to the real thing to spot what they got right and what they missed.

What I found most useful is the time-saving idea behind the whole approach, especially the bird's-eye view in the first pass. If I try to read a paper from start to finish without first understanding what it's about, I end up bombarded with information on a topic I don't even know yet, and I forget half of it by the end. Getting the structure of the paper first, what it's arguing, how it's put together before getting into the details would help gain a better comprehension of the subject matter. I also found Keshav's bluntness funny: "if a reader can't understand a paper's highlights in five minutes, it'll probably never be read at all."

Next time I read a paper, I will implement the first pass before diving in, and treat it as a real decision instead of just giving into my low attention span and skimming it out of impatience. The second and the third pass will push me to mentally engage with a topic I am not familiar with, gain knowledge and walk away with a perspective of my own. To conclude, the three-pass approach organizes the reading process in a way that builds understanding gradually and effectively.

First part: explain the approach

- I applied the three pass approach to glean what the article was about. Guess what...
- simple idea
- Most of us start at the beginning and just to read the whole thing straight through, rawdog it, but that kind of does not work
- First pass - general idea about the paper - read title, abstract, intro. Then subheadings. Then glance over conclusion and references. Five c's
- Second pass - lets you grasp the paper's content but not details - ignore proofs, but look at figures and graphs, checking things like whether axes are labeled properly and whether results have error bars... u should be able to explain it to someone else by the end
- Third pass - you truly understand the paper and reimplement ideas
- Why useful - timesaving (birds eye), unlike when im rawdogging it cause im bombarded with info all at once, and i just forget half of it by the end, efficient
- gettin the structure of the paper, what all its arguing, what references and how its put together help understand tje paper better
- Funny man he is
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